AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A230B
Reading and Studying Literature II
MAIN – ALL BRANCHES
FINAL EXAM
2025-2026/First Semester
Date: 12 Jan. 2026
1:00 – 4:00

umber of Exam Pages: 3 cluding this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** **3 hours**

The duration of the exam is 3 hours.

Answers to Part I questions should be specific. The word count shouldn't exceed 2
words.

Part II answers should be in standard essay format: Start with a thesis in y
ntroduction, develop a critical discussion in the body paragraphs, provide specific a
ppropriate examples, then end with a conclusion. Analyze and discuss examp
oroughly, and define all important terms.

he word count for each essay in part II should be within the range of 350 words.

efer to relevant critical theory to support your argument.

ay attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.

oss out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.

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Section I: Short Answer Questions. (14 marks)

Choose ANY TWO of the following to discuss in less than 200 words (7 marks each)

1. Analyze the use of 'creolized English' as the narrative voice in *The Lonely Londoners*. Explain what the term entails and its effect.

2. What is an epistolary novel? Define the form, discuss its key features and narrative effects, and illustrate your answer with an example from the works you've studied.

3. Define 'free indirect speech' and explain how James Joyce employs this technique in one of the stories from *Dubliners*.

Section II: Essay Questions. (36 marks)

Choose ANY TWO of the following questions to answer. Develop an essay of 350 words each. (18 marks each)

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1. In what ways do Mr. James Duffy in 'A Painful Case' and Gabriel Conroy in 'The Dead' exhibit emotional or social paralysis, and could either have taken steps to change their situations? Why or why not? Discuss how the social and cultural context of Dublin in Joyce's stories contributes to their stagnation and support your answer with specific examples from the texts.

2. Sam Selvon's *The Lonely Londoners* 'deals with the shattering of the illusion of belonging, the illusion of being English, and indeed the illusion about who the English are.' In reference to this statement, discuss how these shattered illusions manifest in the lives of two characters, providing textual support, and situate your argument in the relevant socio-historical context.

3. Compare how the figure of the outsider functions in *Wuthering Heights* and *The Sign of Four* to reveal the underlying tensions, hypocrisies, and vulnerabilities of Victorian domestic spaces. To what extent do these outsiders act as catalysts for revelation, agents of disruption, or symptoms of wider social anxieties?

END OF QUESTIONS

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